

ADVANCED **FUNK** STUDIES

CREATIVE
PATTERNS
FOR THE
ADVANCED
DRUMMER
IN THE STYLES
OF TODAY'S
LEADING
FUNK
DRUMMERS

..also includes transcriptions of many well-known recordings.

CDs Included

RICK LATHAM

"Advanced Funk Studies is excellent. The book is well written and the Tapes are so helpful. This will cause me to practice a little more."

Louie Bellson
Author, Clinician
World renown Drum-set artist

"I would recommend Rick Latham's book Advanced Funk Studies to all serious drummers. The notation is extremely well thought out and easy to read."

Jim Chapin
Author, Teacher
The Father of Drum-Set Independent

"Latham's book Advanced Funk Studies is one of the best books on the market dealing with contemporary Funk-Rock techniques. It is helpful to all drummers."

Ed Shaughnessy
Author, Teacher, Clinician
NBC Orchestra, The Tonight Show

"Advanced Funk Studies is a well written and informative addition to drum set literature. You have done a great job of capturing today's drum-set style."

John Beck
Percussion Instructor
Eastman School of Music
Timpanist, Rochester Phil.

"I am very happy to endorse this most interesting/enlightening book ... The sticking alone makes the patterns fun to play."

Colin Bailey
Teacher, Author, and Clinician

"A valuable addition to the area of percussion instruction literature. The recorded material makes the book an especially powerful teaching aid while still allowing sufficient latitude for the student to develop his own styles."

Harold A. Jones
Associate Professor of Music
East Carolina University

"Rick Latham's concept on Funk Drumming is a necessary addition to drum set study. The material is pertinent and challenging..."

Robert Schietroma
Coordinator of Percussion
North Texas State University

"All of the beats sound good and "Cook". There are all two few quality books in this area. Yours is excellent and contains many original ideas."

Henry Okstel
Instructor of Percussion (Drum set)
North Texas State University

*"I think there is a need for a book of this type in advanced playing...
...the excerpts are challenging and interesting."*

Ron Fink
Associate Professor and Author
North Texas State University

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RICK LATHAM

Rick Latham Publishing Company
P.O. Box 67306
Los Angeles, CA. 90067

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Cover design by M. Heather Dickie
Music notation hand engraved by Rick Latham

TO Harold A. Jones
...for his inspiration

About the Author

The success of his best-selling drum text, *Advanced Funk Studies*, launched Rick Latham into the international percussion spotlight. However, it has been his expertise as a versatile performer that has made him one of contemporary drumming's most respected players.

Rick started drumming at the age of twelve. Initially self-taught, his ears led him to such powerful rhythm and blues influences as the hit Motown and Atlantic label recording artists of the day.

Playing club dates during his high school years in North and South Carolina, Rick attended to the technical aspects of drumming, but his primary focus was playing the "groove." Later, while earning a Bachelor of Arts degree in Percussion Performance at East Carolina University, he expanded his rhythmic and percussion related vocabulary, studying mallets and timpani under Harold Jones. It was during this period that he performed with such jazz greats as Bill Watrous, David Samuels, Jerry Coker and David Friedman.

In 1977, he was granted a teaching assistantship at North Texas State University, where he taught mallets and snare while working on his Masters Degree in Percussion with Robert Schietroma and Ron Fink, and studying drumset with Jim Hall. The inspiration and knowledge Rick gained from these instructors prompted him to create *Advanced Funk Studies*. A text of original concepts, transcriptions of recorded works by his favorite drummers, and accompanied by audio cassettes, *Advanced Funk Studies* was an immediate hit, establishing itself as a leading source of reference with drummers and educators the world over. After his years at NTSU, he began realizing his dream of becoming a professional touring musician in 1979 and toured extensively throughout the United States and Canada. He returned to Texas in the early 80s. In Dallas, he became a member of R&B "Bass Legend" Chuck Rainey's band *Rainey Man* and continued his career as a session player and sought-after sideman with such greats as bluesman B.B. King.

In 1984, Rick relocated to Los Angeles, where he has since enjoyed the opportunity of performing with a long list of leading figures including rockers Edgar Winter, Rick Derringer and Pat Travers, as well as jazz guitarist Howard Roberts. His versatility has also been highlighted with such top entertainers as Rita Moreno, Ben Vereen and Redd Foxx, in addition to his contributions on the theme for television's "9 to 5" series, "Fame," the Quincy Jones produced soundtrack *Fast Forward* and more recently the DVD release of *Gone in 60 Seconds*. In 1990, he released his second successful book *Contemporary Drumset Techniques* and soon afterwards the much anticipated instructional videos that parallel these works.

He has firmly established himself as a world-class artist. Appearances at such major gatherings as Germany's Koblenz International Drummer's Meeting and the Frankfurt Music Messe, the United States NAMM shows, Switzerland's Montreux Jazz Festival and numerous performances throughout Europe and Asia have provided the uninitiated with the opportunity to witness one of the new masters of contemporary drumming.

In addition to maintaining a full playing schedule in Los Angeles along with doing sessions and teaching, Rick involves himself with producing and leading his own jazz group *Rick Latham and The Groove Doctors*. For more information please visit his web site at <http://www.ricklatham.com>.

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PREFACE

The purpose of this book is to give the advanced drummer some insight into the techniques involved in playing today's Funk and Fusion Music. The patterns in this text are to provide the player with a working knowledge of style and feel to develop his own ideas. The information within is merely a means to an end.

I have used a "stems up" notation which I think will be helpful in interpreting the patterns, since traditional notation sometimes tends to be confusing. The cassette tape that accompanies this book will serve as an invaluable aid in the realization of the patterns set forth.

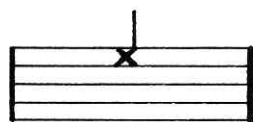
Many of the patterns are styled after some of today's leading funk drummers such as Steve Gadd, Harvey Mason, and David Garibaldi. Others are direct transcriptions from recordings as indicated.

The first section of this book contains exercises which employ various techniques necessary to master the patterns that follow. These exercises will be divided into three types; those dealing with (1) the Hi Hat, (2) the Snare Drum, and (3) the Bass Drum.

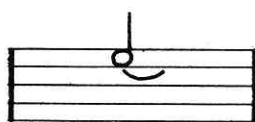
Many of these patterns will not be mastered in mere minutes. Begin them at a slow tempo, paying close attention to **accents** and **sticking**. Remember to always maintain the evenness and flow of the pattern at any tempo.

EXPLANATION OF NOTATION

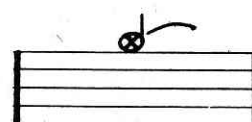
The notation used in this book is basically standard percussion notation. I have used some symbols with which the reader may be unfamiliar.



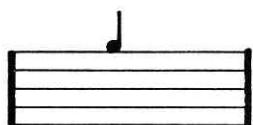
HI-HAT



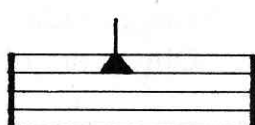
OPEN HI-HAT



CYMBAL



BELL OF CYMBAL



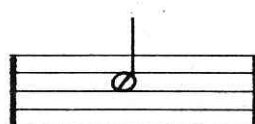
COW BELL



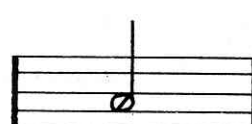
SNARE DRUM



SMALL TOM-TOM



MIDDLE TOM-TOM



FLOOR TOM-TOM



BASS DRUM

FOUR BASIC HI-HAT OPENINGS



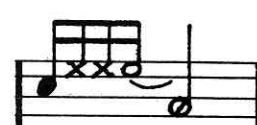
Open on the beat,
closed on next beat.



Open on "and" of beat,
closed on next beat.



Open on "e" of beat,
closed on next beat.



Open on "ah" of beat,
closed on next beat.

PERFORMANCE NOTES

Many of the patterns in this book, when first played, will seem very straight and stiff. It will take a short time to achieve the proper style and feel of each pattern. Here are a few basic suggestions that will help in achieving a good sound and feel.

GHOST STROKES — Sometimes it will be necessary to **GHOST** certain strokes. This simply means that the stroke is more implied rather than actually sounded. A good example of this practice is shown in the pattern, . The Hi-Hat on the "and" of the beat should be barely audible, so that the pattern sounds like .

DOUBLE STROKES — When playing **unaccented** double strokes, be sure that they are even and match or balance in volume level.

DOUBLE STOPS — When playing a combination of both hands or hand(s) and foot (feet) together be sure there is one sound, **not** a flam effect.

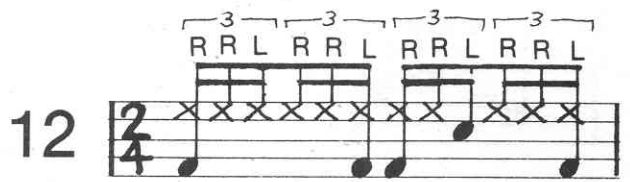
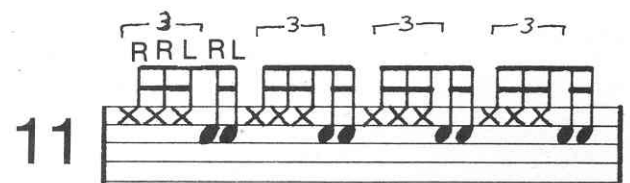
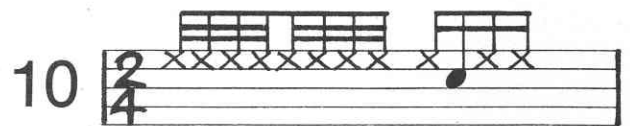
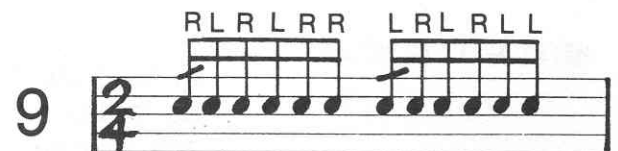
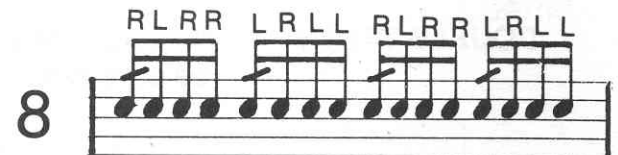
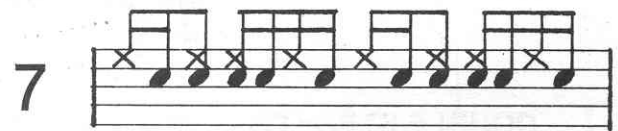
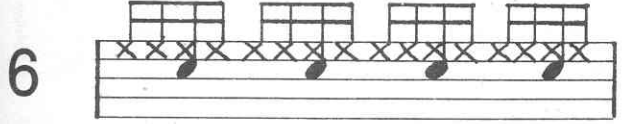
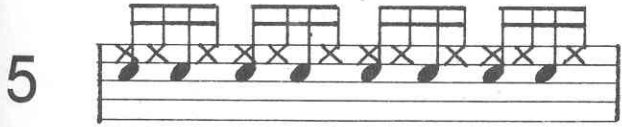
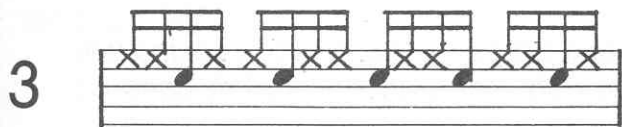
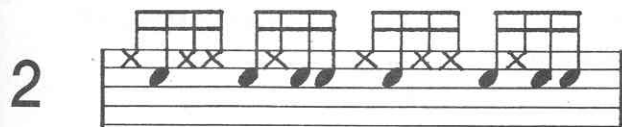
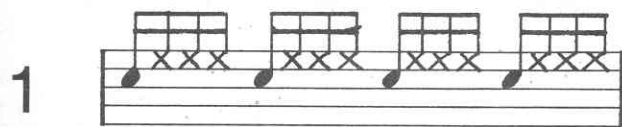
All exercises with no time signature are in 4/4 time—all other time signatures are notated.

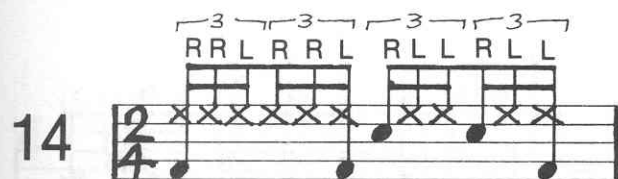
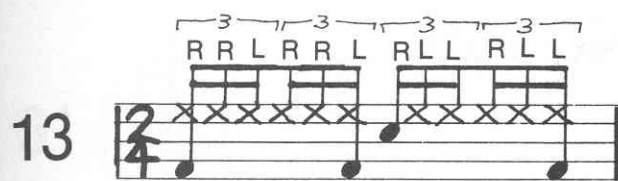
In the Funk Patterns, Transcriptions, and Solos—only special sticking will be indicated. All other sticking will be right hand on Hi-Hat, left hand on snare drum.

INTRODUCTORY EXERCISES

The following exercises deal with different combinations of the Hi-Hat, Snare drum, Bass drum, and Tom-Toms. The sticking should be strictly followed; this will be helpful in achieving the correct sound and feel of the exercise. These stickings will also be helpful in learning the patterns and transcriptions that follow.

Some of the exercises will not have sticking indicated. These should be practiced right hand on Hi-Hat, left hand on Snare Drum and left hand on Hi-Hat, right hand on Snare Drum. These will be indicated throughout the book by*.





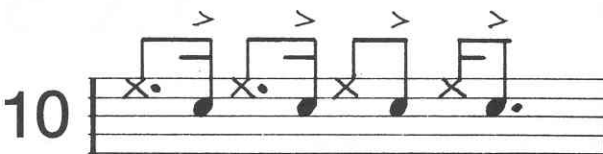
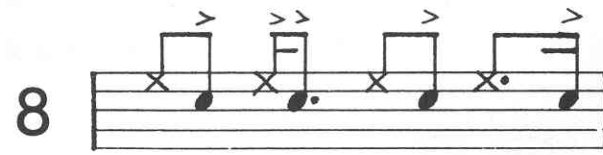
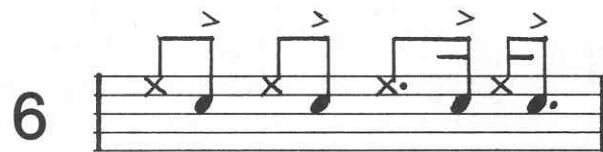
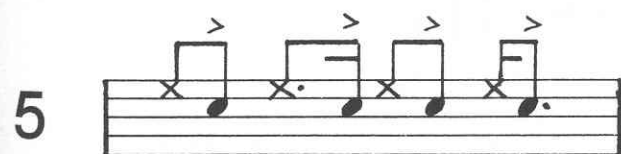
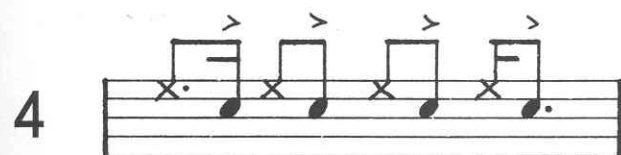
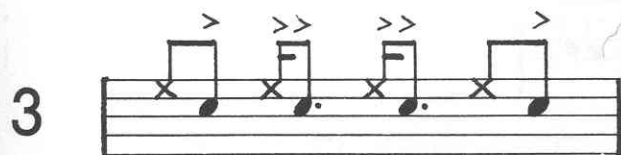
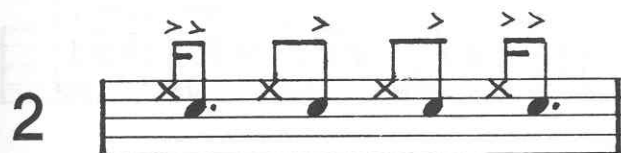
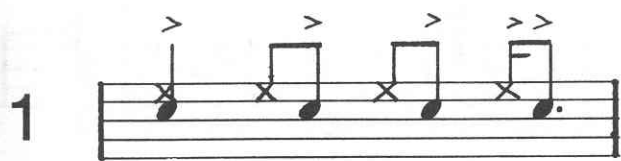
FIXED HI-HAT PATTERNS

This next group of exercises deals with four basic Hi-Hat sticking patterns found in Funk Drumming.

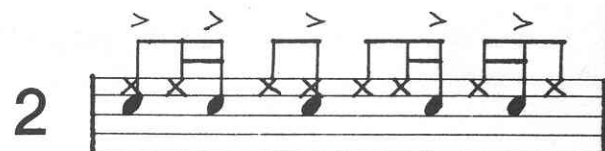
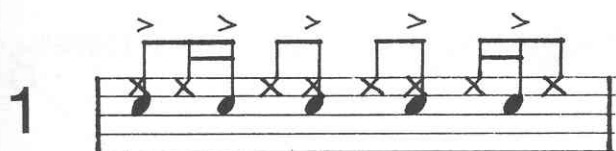
- (1) Hi-Hat plays quarter notes
- (2) Hi-Hat plays eighth notes
- (3) Hi-Hat plays on the "and" of the beat (off beat)
- (4) Hi-Hat plays sixteenth notes on the "and-ah" of the beat

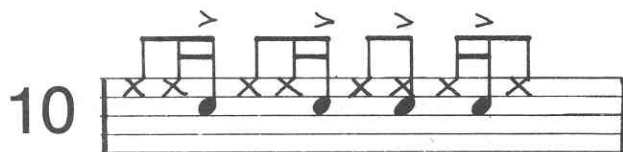
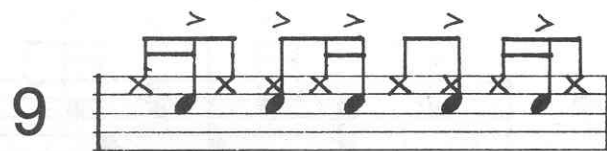
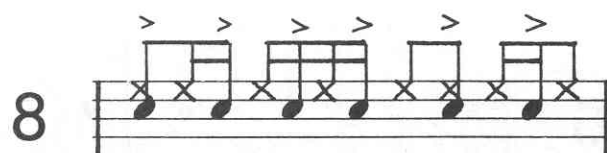
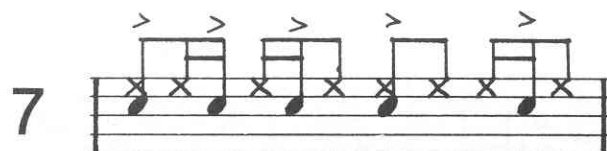
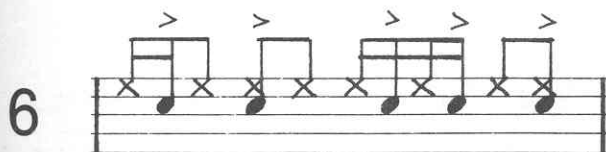
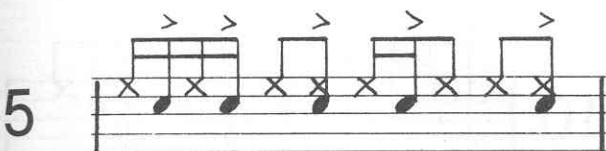
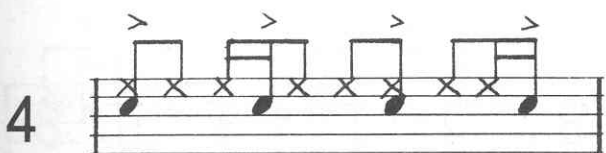
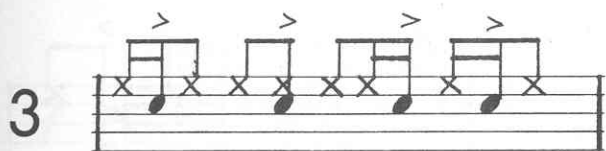
For a more effective feel, play a Bass Drum dotted eighth-sixteenth or Samba pattern with these exercises.*

HI-HAT QUARTER NOTES



HI-HAT EIGHTH NOTES



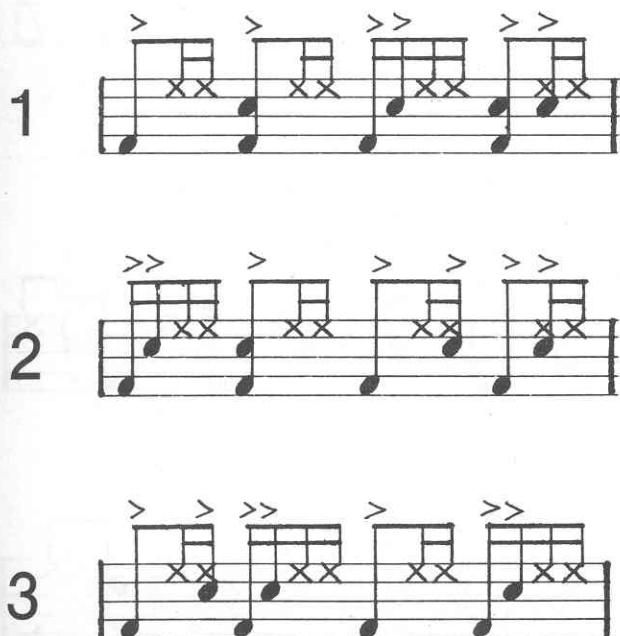


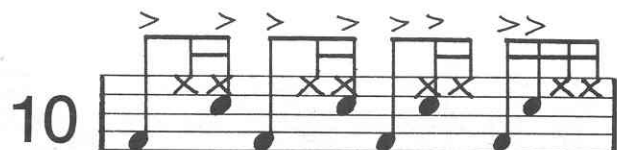
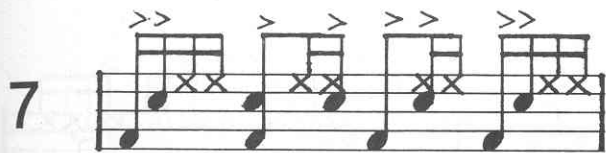
HI-HAT OFF BEAT





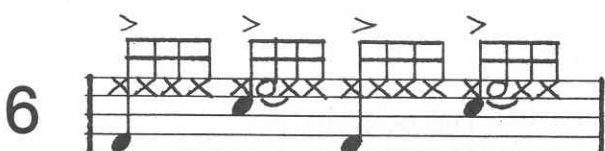
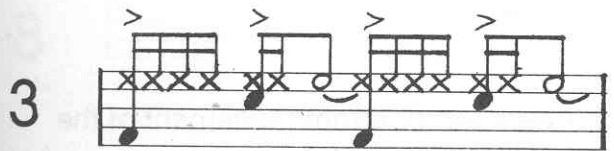
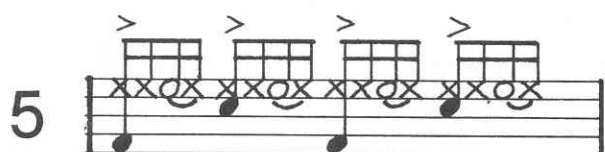
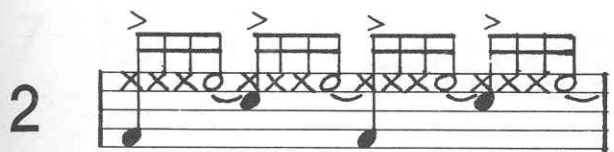
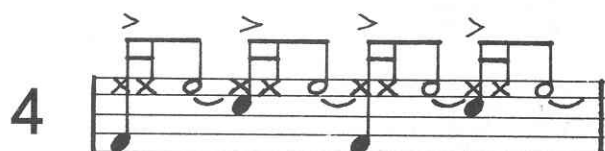
HI-HAT SIXTEENTH NOTES (and-ah)

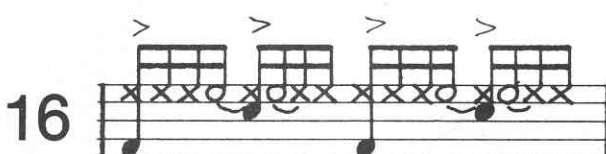
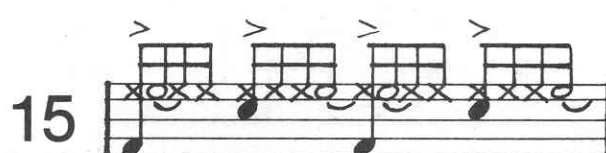
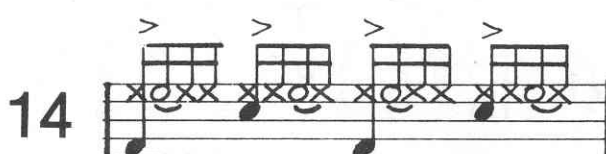
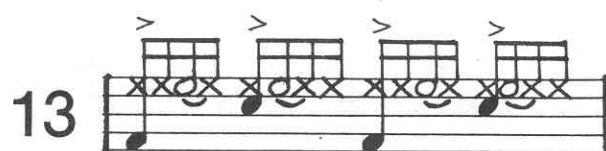
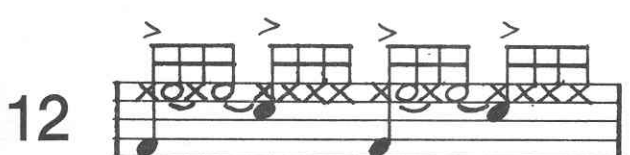
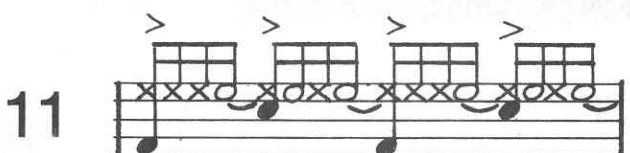
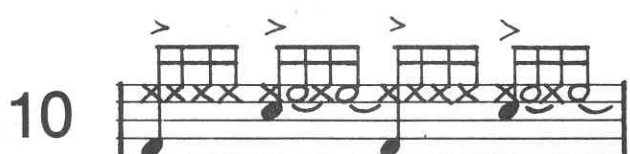
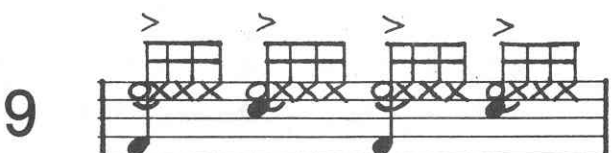
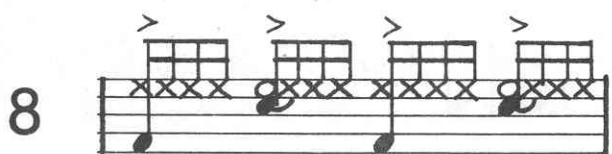
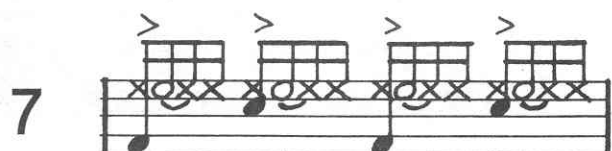




HI-HAT OPENINGS

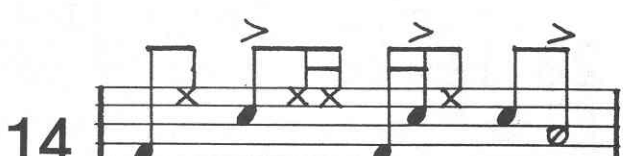
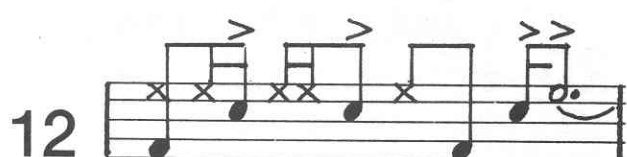
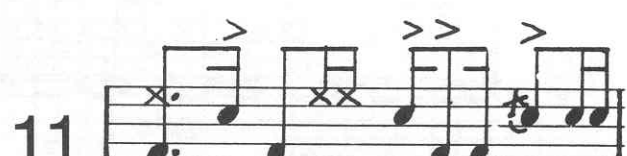
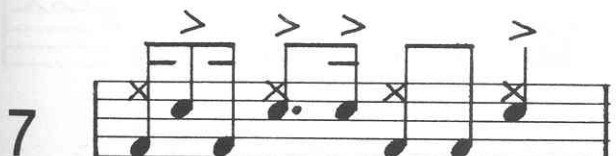
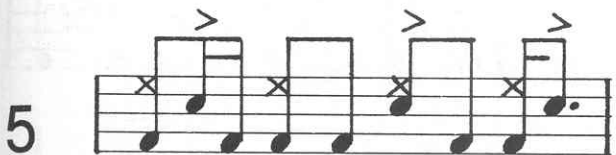
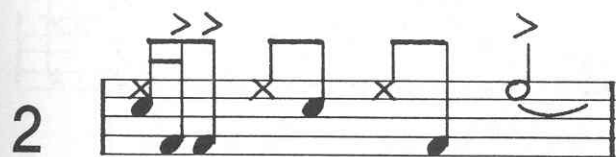
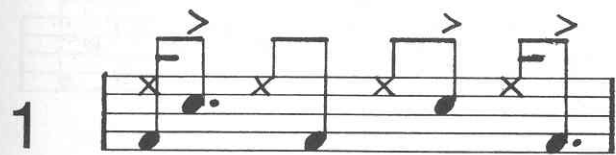
These exercises deal with opening the Hi-Hat on different parts of the beat, creating the **SHUP...** sound.* Also try these using alternating sticking.





COMBINATION EXERCISES

The combination exercises deal with what has been covered thus far; different placement of the Hi-Hat, Snare Drum, Bass Drum, and Tom-Toms, as well as sticking problems.*



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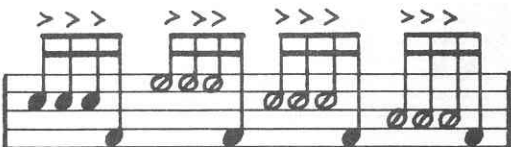
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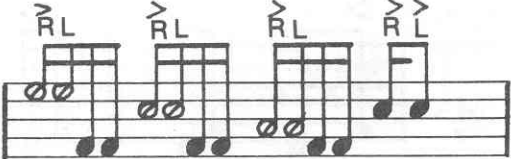
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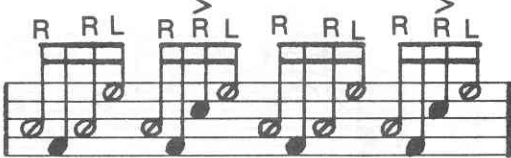
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FILL PATTERNS

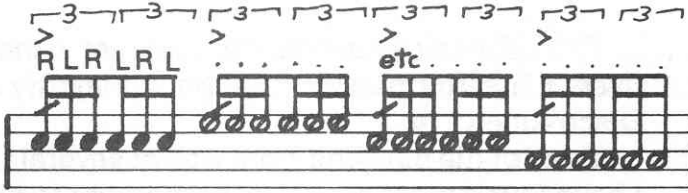
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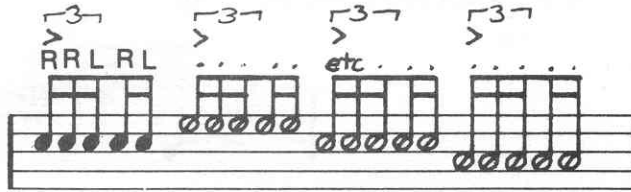
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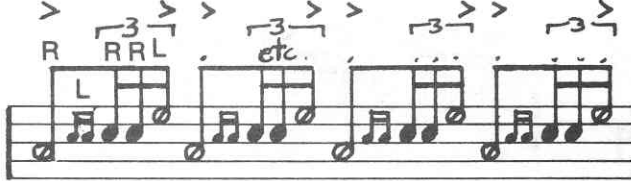
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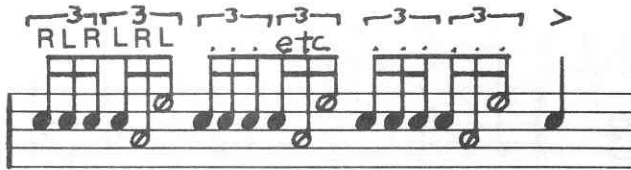
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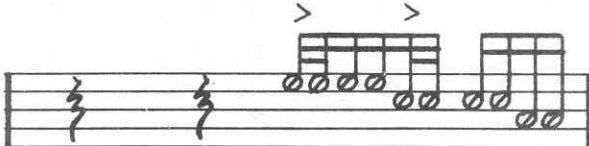
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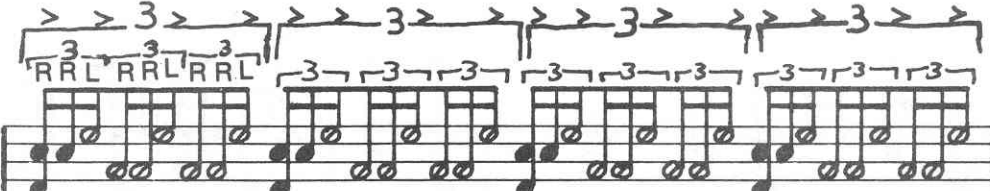
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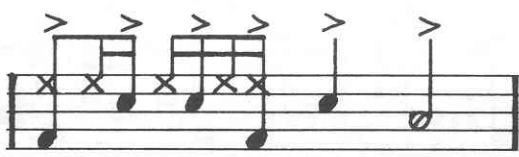
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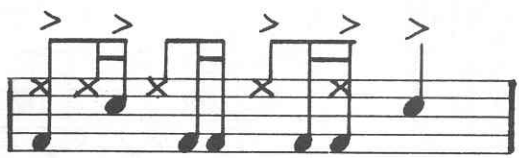
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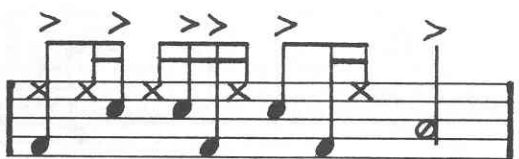
FUNK PATTERNS

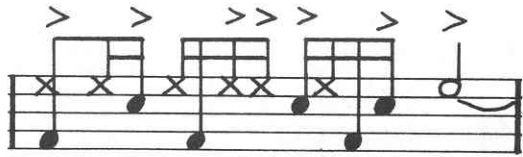
This section ties everything together in the form of patterns, one or two measures long, that can be used in a performance situation. A majority of these patterns can be used in some of today's Funk-Disco tunes.

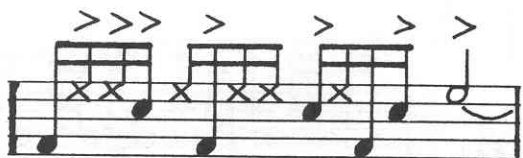
Many of the patterns work well at several tempos. On the cassette they will be played at the tempo I have found most effective. Remember to start these patterns at a slow tempo, paying close attention to sticking and accents.

1 

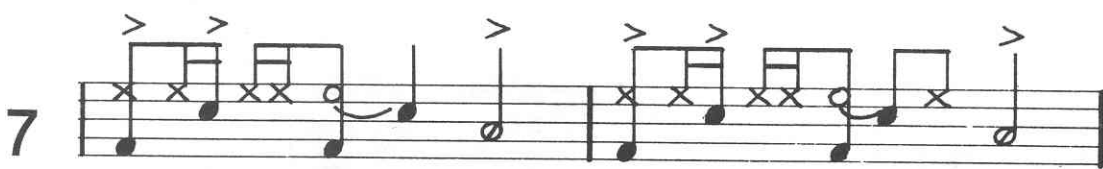
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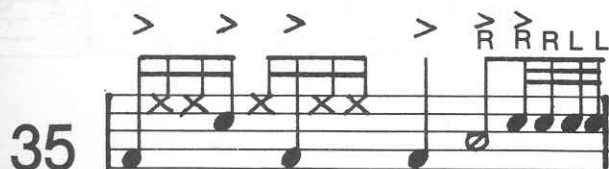
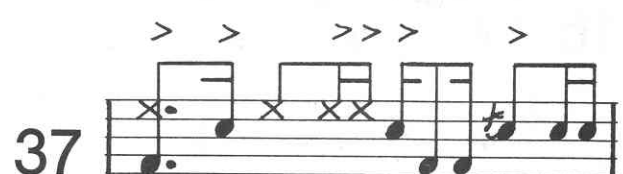
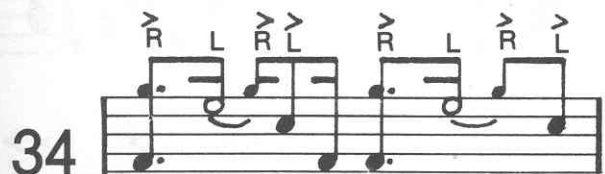
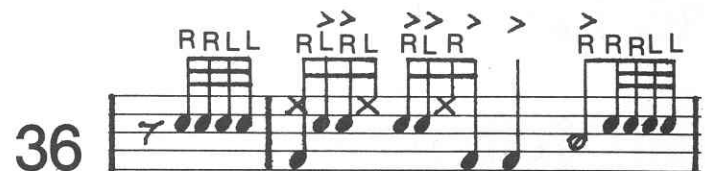
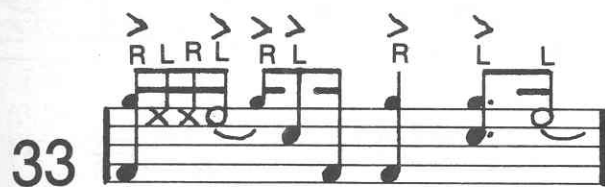
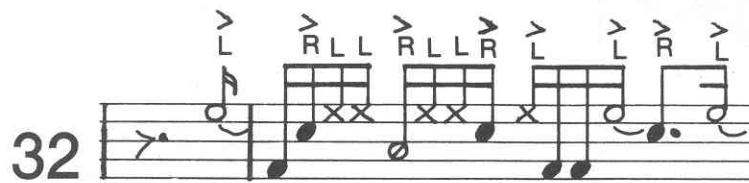
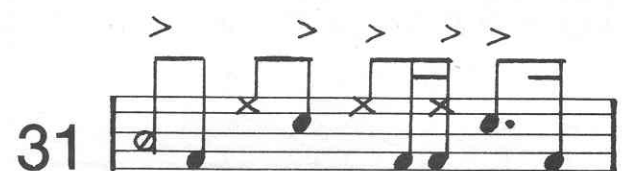
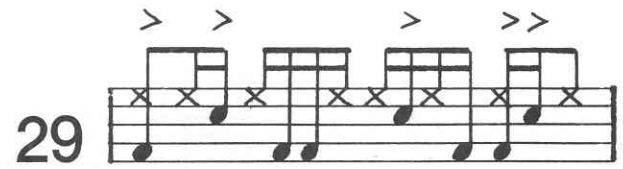
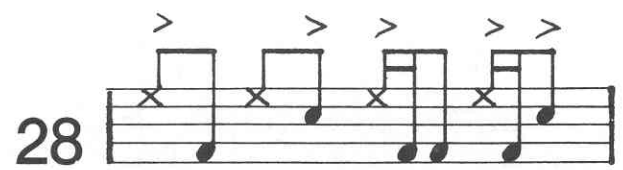
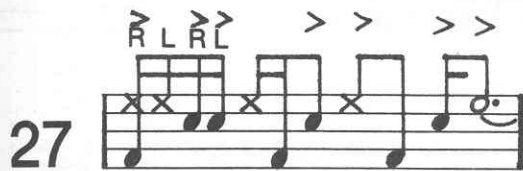
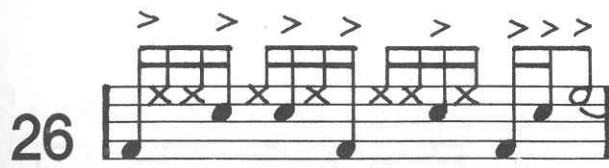
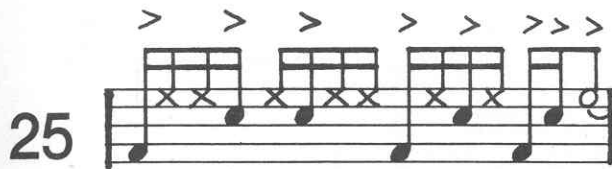
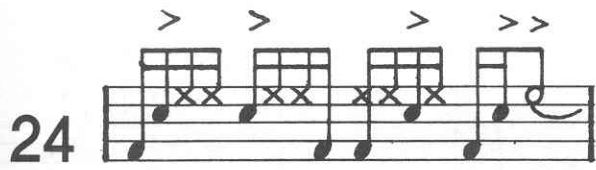
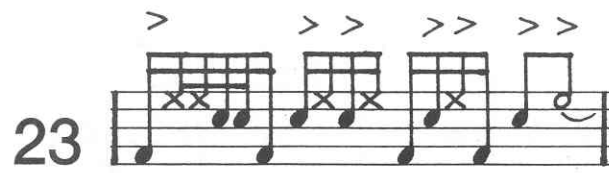
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(Hi-Hat with Foot)

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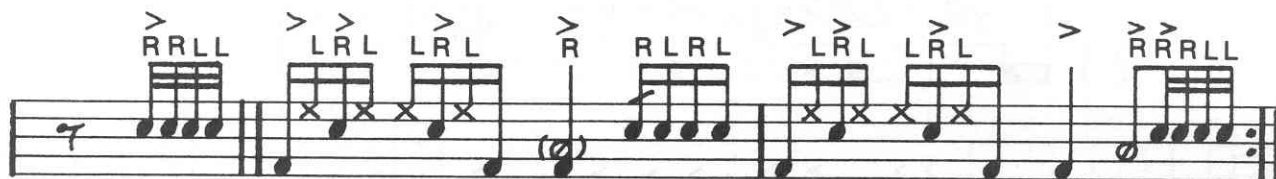
TRANSCRIPTIONS

The following beats and solos are some of my favorites that I have transcribed over the last few years. These are to give you some understanding of the style and technique used by some of the top Funk Drummers today and to help develop your own style and technique.

I hope that you will find them enjoyable and useful.

STEVE GADD

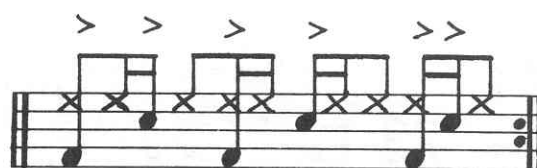
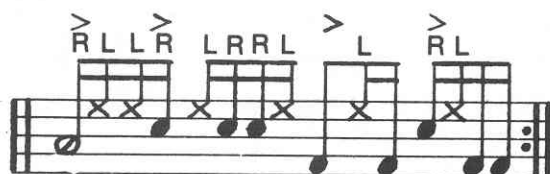
1 “50 Ways To Leave Your Lover” From Paul Simon; **Still Crazy** ♪ = 100



2 “Lenore” from Chick Corea; **The Leprechaun**

A  = 126

B  = 120

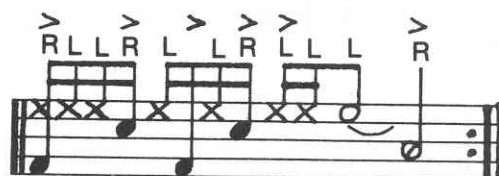


3 “The Musician” from Chick Corea; **Music Magic** ♪ = 104

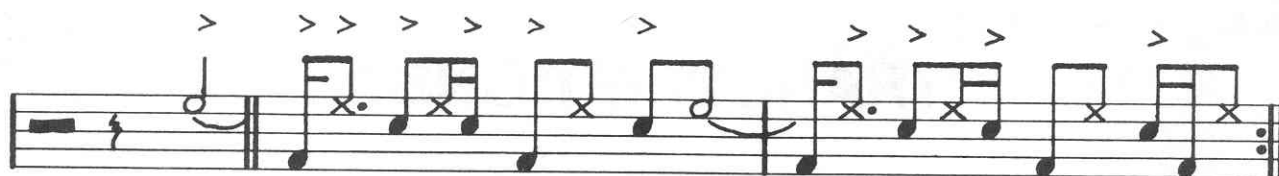
A



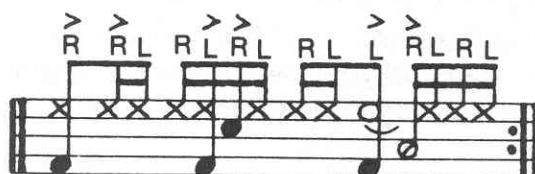
B



4 “I Love Wastin’ Time With You” from The Brecker Brothers; **Back to Back** = 116



5 "I've Got The Melody" (Deep In My Heart)" from Kenny Loggins; **Celebrate Me Home** ♩ = 116



6 "Midtown Rush" from Tom Scott; **New York Connection** ♩ = 104

A

B

7 "Dirty Old Man" from Tom Scott; **New York Connection** ♩ = 92

8 "Looking Out For Number 7" from Tom Scott; **New York Connection** ♩ = 184

9 "Touchdown" from Bob James; **Touchdown** ♩ = 112

A

B

10 "Seven Steps To Heaven" from Ben Sidran; **The Cat And The Hat** ♩ = 126

Exercise 10: "Seven Steps To Heaven" from Ben Sidran; **The Cat And The Hat** ♩ = 126. The notation shows three staves of music with various rhythmic patterns and footwork indicators (R, L) above the notes.

11 "Hop Scotch" from Jeremy Steig; **Firefly** ♩ = 98

Exercise 11: "Hop Scotch" from Jeremy Steig; **Firefly** ♩ = 98. The notation shows a single staff of music with various rhythmic patterns and footwork indicators (R, L) above the notes.

12 "If You Want It" from Bobbi Humphrey; **Freestyle** ♩ = 108

Exercise 12: "If You Want It" from Bobbi Humphrey; **Freestyle** ♩ = 108. The notation shows three staves of music with various rhythmic patterns and footwork indicators (R, L) above the notes.

13 "Skat Talk" from Mark Colby; **One Good Turn** ♩ = 98

A

B

14 "Dream" from Esther Phillips; **Capricorn Princess** ♩ = 138

15 "This Time Tomorrow" from Neil Larsen; **High Gear** ♩ = 98

A

B

DAVID GARIBALDI

16 "Ebony Jam" from Tower of Power; **In The Slot** ♩ = 108

17 "On The Serious Side" from Tower of Power; **In The Slot** ♩ = 116



18 "Squib Cakes" from Tower of Power; **Back To Oakland** ♩ = 108

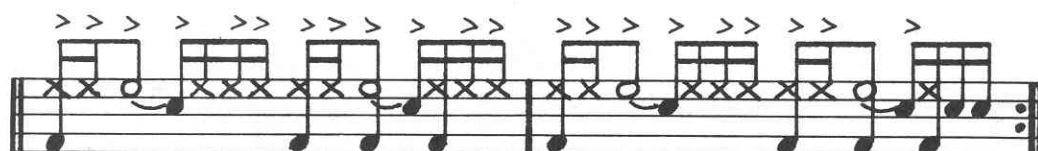


HARVEY MASON

19 "Bertha Baptist" from Harvey Mason; **Earthmover** ♩ = 120



20 "The Mase" from Harvey Mason; **Earthmover** ♩ = 94

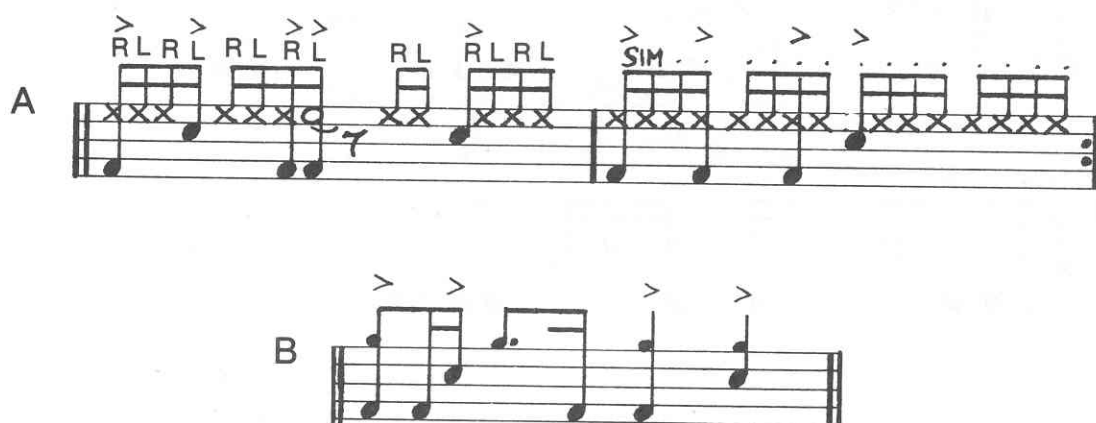


21 "Phantazia" from Harvey Mason; **Funk In A Mason Jar** ♩ = 120
(First four measures of bass solo)



PETER ERSKINE

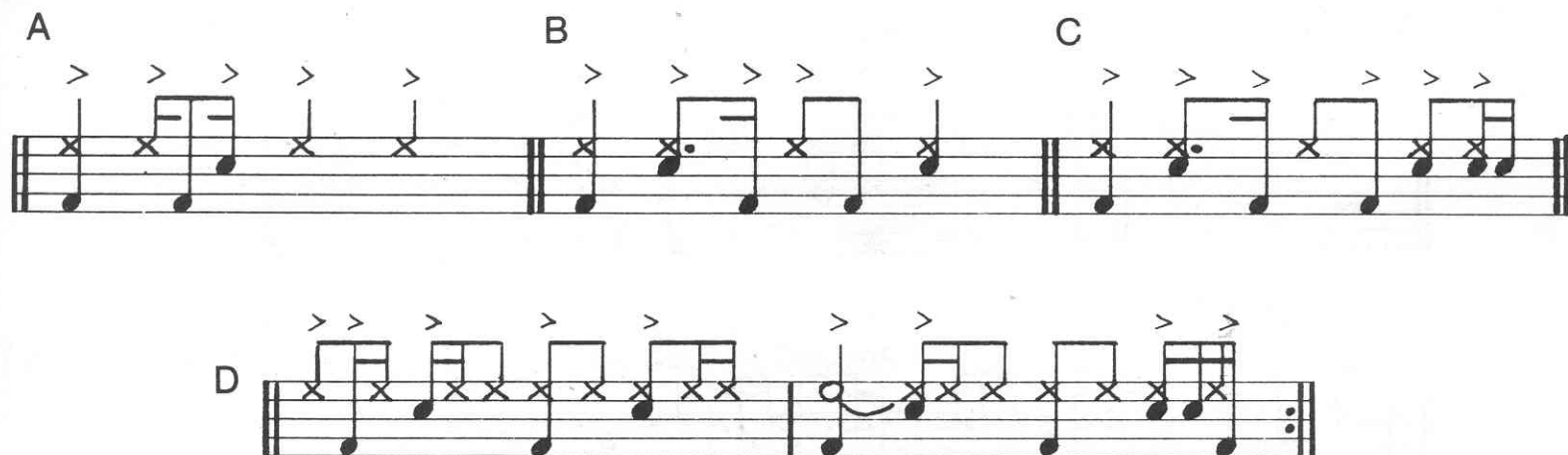
22 "Acrobat" from John Serry; **Jazziz** ♩ = 116



23 "Do It" from Michel Colombier; **Michel Colombier** ♩ = 110



24 "Take Me Down" from Michel Colombier; **Michel Colombier** ♩ = 90



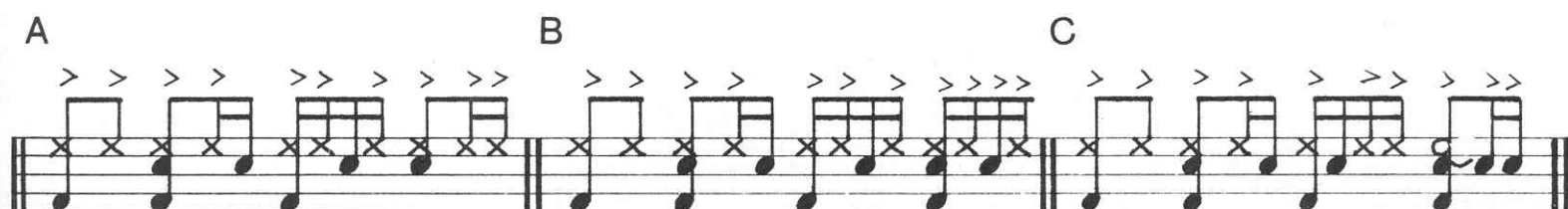
GERRY BROWN

25 "Funky Row" from John Lee and Gerry Brown; **Still Can't Say Enough** ♩ = 98



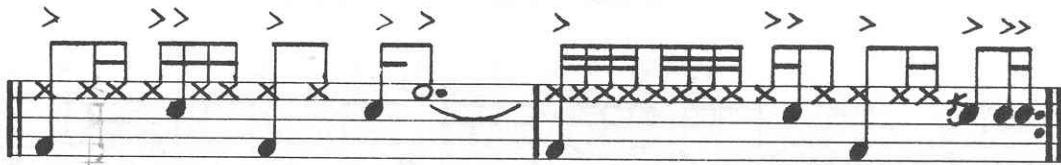
PAUL LEIM

26 "I Wanna Be With You" from Doc Severinson; **Night Journey** ♩ = 92



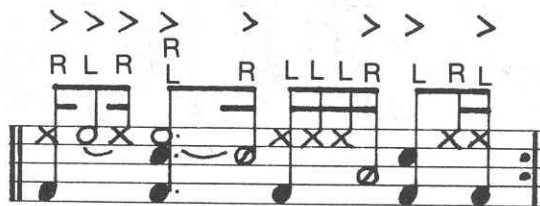
RICHARD "MOON" CALHOUN

27 "Turn" from Rufus; **Street Player** ♩ = 82



ED GREENE

28 "Shake Your Body" (Down To The Ground)" from The Jacksons; **Destiny** ♩ = 116



SOLOS

The solos that follow use the patterns that you have worked with throughout the book. Each solo has its own special problems that should be worked out very carefully. This will help in achieving an even flow of the solo.

These solos represent different **grooves** or **feels** that are very popular in today's music. Certain solos will bring to mind certain players.

You will find that the solos makes excellent lesson material or very challenging jury and recital pieces.

SOLO #1

♩ = 120

The musical score for SOLO #1 consists of 10 staves of rhythmic notation. The notation is primarily based on eighth and sixteenth notes, often grouped in pairs or fours. Many notes are marked with an accent (>) or a slur. Some notes are marked with an 'x' above them, possibly indicating a specific articulation or a cross-stick. The first staff begins with a rest followed by two eighth notes with accents. The second staff continues with a series of eighth notes, some with 'x' marks. The third staff features a mix of eighth and sixteenth notes, with some groups of four sixteenth notes. The fourth staff shows a continuation of the eighth-note patterns. The fifth staff introduces a triplet of eighth notes marked 'RLRL' and a group of eighth notes marked 'RL RL RL'. The sixth staff begins with a triplet of eighth notes marked 'RLR' and continues with eighth-note patterns. The seventh staff features a series of eighth notes with accents. The eighth staff continues with eighth-note patterns. The ninth staff shows a mix of eighth and sixteenth notes, with some groups of four sixteenth notes. The tenth staff concludes with a final eighth note and a double bar line.

SOLO #2

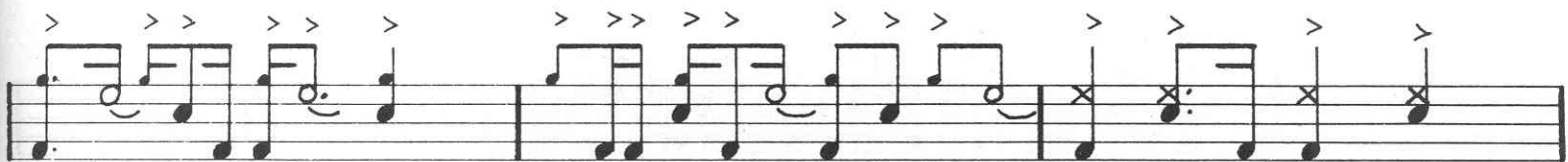
♩ = 100

The musical score consists of nine staves. The notation includes various rhythmic values and patterns, often grouped with 'x' marks. Fingerings (1, 2, 3, 4) are indicated above notes. Accents (>) are placed over many notes. Dynamic markings include 'SIM.' (Sforzando) and 'f' (forte). The score concludes with a double bar line and a repeat sign.

SOLO #3

♩ = 126

The musical score for Solo #3 consists of ten staves of rhythmic notation. The notation includes various symbols such as '>', '>>', 'x', 'o', and 'SIM.' (Simultaneous). The staves are organized into four measures per staff, with some measures containing a double bar line and a '2' indicating a repeat or a specific count. The notation is written on a single-line staff, likely representing a single melodic line or a specific instrument's part. The overall structure is a continuous sequence of rhythmic patterns across the ten staves.



SOLO #4

♩ = 132

The musical score consists of ten staves. The first staff begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). The tempo is marked as 132 beats per minute. The notation includes various rhythmic patterns, such as eighth and sixteenth notes, and rests. Above the notes, there are rhythmic patterns like "RLRL RLRL" and "RLLR LRLR". Dynamic markings like ">" are used throughout. The score ends with a double bar line and a "2" indicating a final measure.



SOLO #5

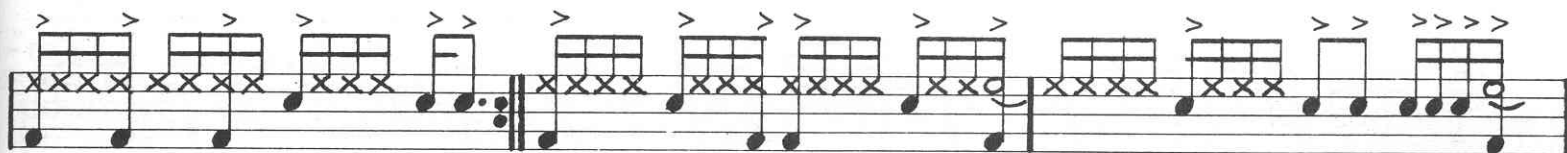
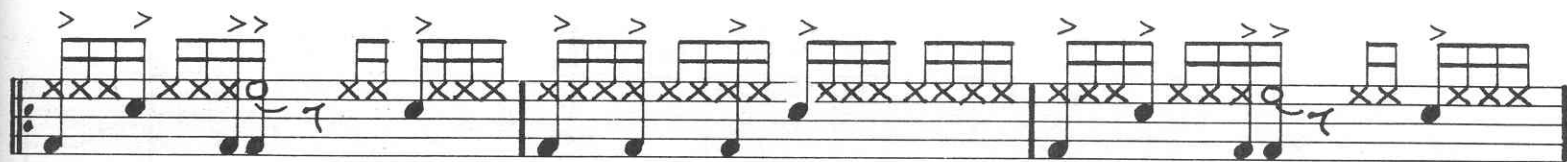
♩ = 116



SOLO #6

♩ = 120

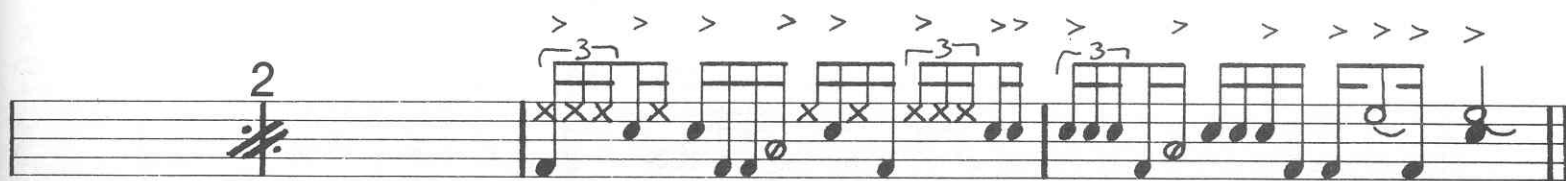
This page contains ten staves of musical notation for a guitar exercise. The notation includes various rhythmic patterns, accidentals, and dynamic markings. The first staff begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). The notation is written in a style that suggests a specific guitar technique, possibly a form of fingerstyle or a specific strumming pattern. The notation includes many 'x' marks, which likely represent fretted notes or specific techniques. The notation is organized into measures, with some measures containing multiple notes and others containing single notes or rests. The notation is written in a way that is easy to read and understand, with clear markings for notes, rests, and accidentals. The notation is written in a style that is common in guitar sheet music, with a focus on clarity and ease of interpretation. The notation is written in a way that is easy to read and understand, with clear markings for notes, rests, and accidentals. The notation is written in a style that is common in guitar sheet music, with a focus on clarity and ease of interpretation.



SOLO #7

♩ = 116

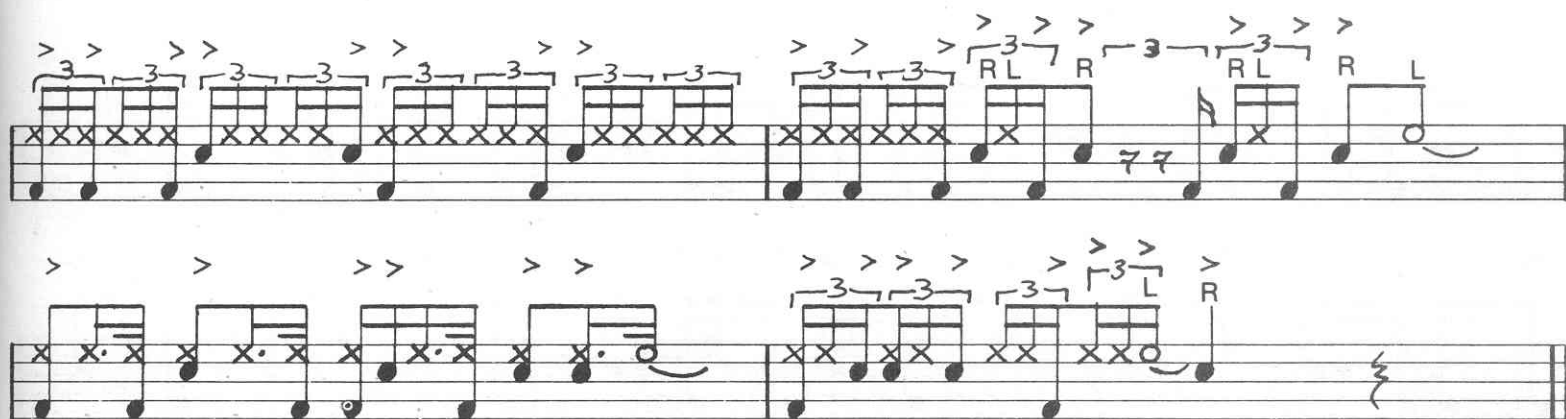
The musical score for SOLO #7 consists of ten staves of drum notation. The notation includes various rhythmic patterns, triplets, and dynamic markings. The first staff begins with a triplet of eighth notes (RRL) followed by a quarter note (R) and a quarter note (LRL). The second staff features a triplet of eighth notes (RRL) followed by a quarter note (RL). The third staff starts with a quarter note (R) followed by a quarter note (LRL). The fourth staff begins with a quarter note (R) followed by a quarter note (LRL). The fifth staff starts with a quarter note (R) followed by a quarter note (LRL). The sixth staff begins with a quarter note (R) followed by a quarter note (LRL). The seventh staff starts with a quarter note (R) followed by a quarter note (LRL). The eighth staff begins with a quarter note (R) followed by a quarter note (LRL). The ninth staff starts with a quarter note (R) followed by a quarter note (LRL). The tenth staff begins with a quarter note (R) followed by a quarter note (LRL). The score includes various rhythmic patterns, triplets, and dynamic markings throughout.



SOLO #8

♩ = 88-92

The musical score for Solo #8 consists of ten staves of music. The notation includes various rhythmic patterns, triplets, and fingerings. The first staff begins with a series of eighth notes and quarter notes, some marked with accents (>) and slurs. The second staff introduces triplets and specific fingerings (RRL, LRL, RRL, R). The third staff continues with similar patterns, including triplets and slurs. The fourth staff features more complex triplet patterns and slurs. The fifth staff includes a double bar line and two measures of rest, each marked with a '2' and a double bar line. The sixth staff continues with rhythmic patterns and slurs. The seventh staff includes a double bar line and two measures of rest, each marked with a '%' symbol. The eighth staff continues with rhythmic patterns and slurs. The ninth staff includes a double bar line and two measures of rest, each marked with a '%' symbol. The tenth staff concludes the solo with a final rhythmic pattern and a double bar line.



SOLO #9

♩ = 132

The musical score for SOLO #9 consists of ten staves. The tempo is marked as ♩ = 132. The notation includes various rhythmic values, accidentals, and dynamic markings. Above the notes, there are numerous accent marks (>) and some specific rhythmic notations like 'RL', 'RR', and '3'. The score is divided into measures by vertical bar lines, with a 2/4 time signature change indicated in the third staff. The music is written on a single-line staff with a key signature of one sharp (F#).



SOLO #10

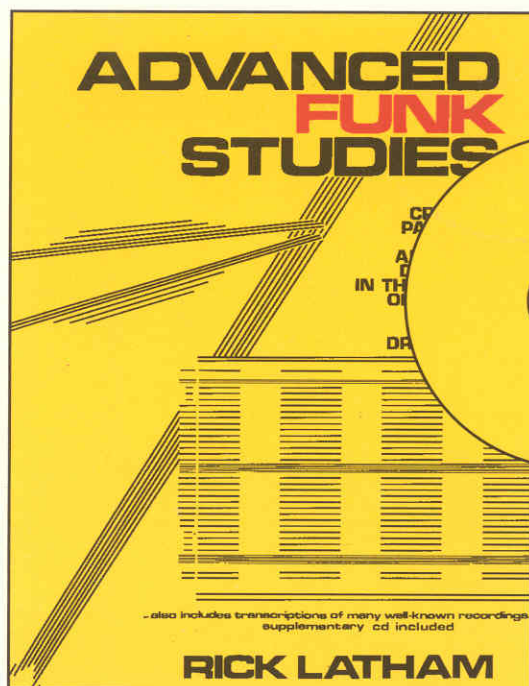
$d = 72$ HALF X FEEL

This page contains ten staves of musical notation for a drum solo. The notation is written on a single system of ten staves. The music features various rhythmic patterns, including eighth, quarter, and half notes, as well as rests and slurs. Above the notes are various rhythmic markings, including accents (>) and slurs (>>). Some notes are marked with 'x' to indicate specific drum sounds. The notation is written on a single system of ten staves.



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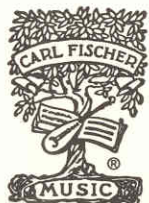


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